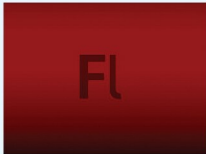


Developers ask Adobe to open source Flash Player

Many developers have not welcomed Adobe's decision to end support for the Flash Player plugin in 2020. Thus, a petition seeking the open source availability of Flash Player has been released on GitHub.

While Adobe may have plenty of reasons to kill Flash, there are a bunch of developers who want to save it. GitHub user Juha Lindstedt, the developer who has filed the petition, believes that Flash is an important part of the Internet's history. Killing support for Flash means that future generations would not be able to access old games, websites and experiments, Lindstedt has said.



"Open sourcing Flash specs would be a good solution to keep Flash projects alive safely for archival reasons," the developer wrote in the petition.

Interestingly, over 3,400 people have so far signed the petition, which compares Adobe Flash with saving and restoring of old manuscripts. The developers who've signed the petition also want the interactive artwork created with Flash to be saved.

The petition clearly states that it is not requesting Adobe to release the licensed components. Instead, the petitioners are ready to volunteer for either bypassing the licensed components or to replace them with open source alternatives.

World's first software-defined data centre gets launched in India

Pi Datacenters, India's native enterprise-class data centre and cloud services provider, has launched Asia's largest Tier IV-certified data centre in Amaravati, Vijayawada. The company claims the new offering, called Pi Amaravati, is the world's first software-defined data centre.



"Pi Amaravati is a major milestone for the entire team," said Kalyan Muppaneni, founder and CEO, Pi Datacenters. The new data centre uses the OpenStack virtualisation framework to deliver an advanced computing, storage and networking experience. It is capable of offering league modular colocation and hosting services with a capacity of up to 5,000 racks. Also, the company's enterprise cloud platform Harbour1 is powered by open source provider SUSE.

Vijayawada-based Pi Datacenters has recently been awarded Uptime Institute Tier IV design certification — known as the highest standard for infrastructure, functionality and capacity.

"With the launch of Pi Amaravati, we will be offering highly innovative and tailored solutions with Infrastructure-as-a-Service (IaaS), Platform-as-a-Service (PaaS), Disaster-Recovery-as-a-Service (DRaaS) and a host of other cloud-enabled product and services to our esteemed partners," Muppaneni said.

Along with launching the Pi Amaravati data centre, Pi Datacenters has entered into a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with companies like PowerGrid, IRCTC, Mahindra and Mahindra Finance, Deutsche Bank and Unibic. These partnerships will expand open source developments in the data centre space.

LibreOffice 5.4 has 'incremental' compatibility with Microsoft Office files

The Document Foundation has released an update to the LibreOffice 5 series — the version 5.4, which has new features for Writer, Calc and Impress.

In the list of major tweaks over the previous version, the Document Foundation states that there are a large number of 'incremental' improvements to Microsoft Office file compatibility. "Inspired by Leonardo da Vinci's belief that 'simplicity is the ultimate sophistication', LibreOffice developers have focused on file simplicity as the ultimate document interoperability sophistication," said the non-profit organisation in a blog post.



The Writer element of the LibreOffice 5.4 brings improved compatibility for Microsoft Word files. The ODF and OOXML files written by the LibreOffice suite are also more robust and easier to share than before.

The simplicity concept translates the XML description of a new document with 50 per cent smaller ODF/ODT files and 90 per cent smaller OOXML/DOCX files as compared to Microsoft Office.

The other highlight of the latest LibreOffice update is the new standard colour palette based on the RGB colour model. The Document Foundation has integrated better support for embedded videos and OpenPGP keys. Also, the rendering of imported PDF documents is much better in this version.

The new version of Writer can help you import AutoText from MS Word DOTM templates. Users can preserve the file structure of exported or pasted lists